



July 1, 2026

Matthew Goodman
Assistant Attorney General
Public Access Bureau
Illinois Attorney General's Office
115 South LaSalle Street
Chicago, Illinois 60603

Sent via email: matthew.goodman@ilag.gov

RE: FOIA Request for Review: 2026 PAC 94734
 University FOIA No.: 26-968
 Requester: Mr. Samuel Grayson
 FOIA Request Received: April 20, 2026

Dear Matthew Goodman:

I am writing in response to the letter the University of Illinois (University) Freedom of Information Act Office (FOIA Office) received from you on June 22, 2026, regarding the above-referenced Illinois Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request submitted by Mr. Samuel Grayson (Grayson).

FACTS

The University received the FOIA request from Grayson on April 20, 2026. The FOIA request sought the following records:

1. "The most recent ALPR audit from "random auditing", referred to by UI PD Policy Manual 429.2.
2. The most recent ALPR "scheduled audit", referred to described by Policy Manual 429.2
3. The most recent ALPR "regular data quality review", described by UI PD Policy Manual 429.4.3.
4. The most recent ALPR "annual evaluation report", described by UI PD Policy Manual 429.5.2.
5. Training materials including user manuals for Flock ALPR systems including those created for UI PD Policy Manual 429.6 and manuals produced by Flock."

The University replied to Grayson on April 27, 2026, notifying him that the University would be taking an extension for an additional five (5) business days. On May 4, 2026, the University asked Grayson if he would agree to extend the deadline to May 11, 2026, to which he agreed on May 6, 2026. The University issued a response to Grayson on May 11, 2026, advising that a search was conducted and that no responsive records were located.

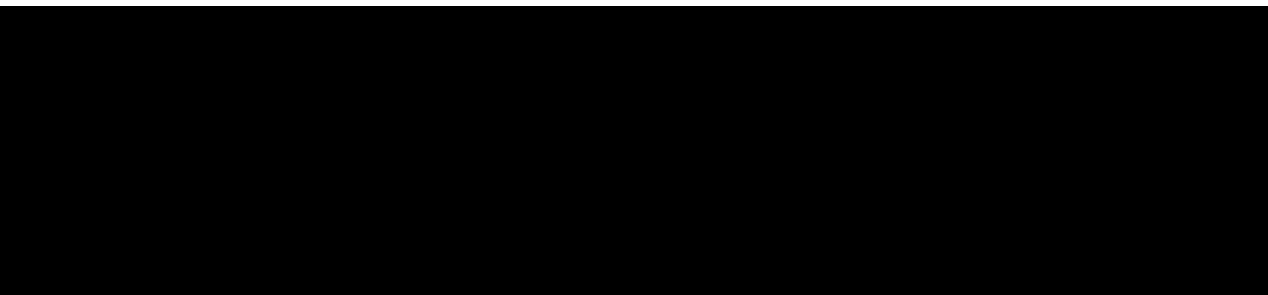
This request for review followed, with Grayson challenging the adequacy of the search.

ARGUMENT

Adequacy of the Search: Items 1-4

Upon receipt of the request, the University identified the Division of Public Safety (DPS), which encompasses the University of Illinois Police Department, as the department most likely to possess responsive records based on the subject matter of the request. The appropriate personnel within DPS conducted searches of relevant systems, including electronic files where they believed responsive materials would reasonably be expected to be maintained.

This information below is confidential and is not to be shared with the Requester:



End of confidential section

No responsive records could be located, and the University's FOIA Office responded to Grayson accordingly.

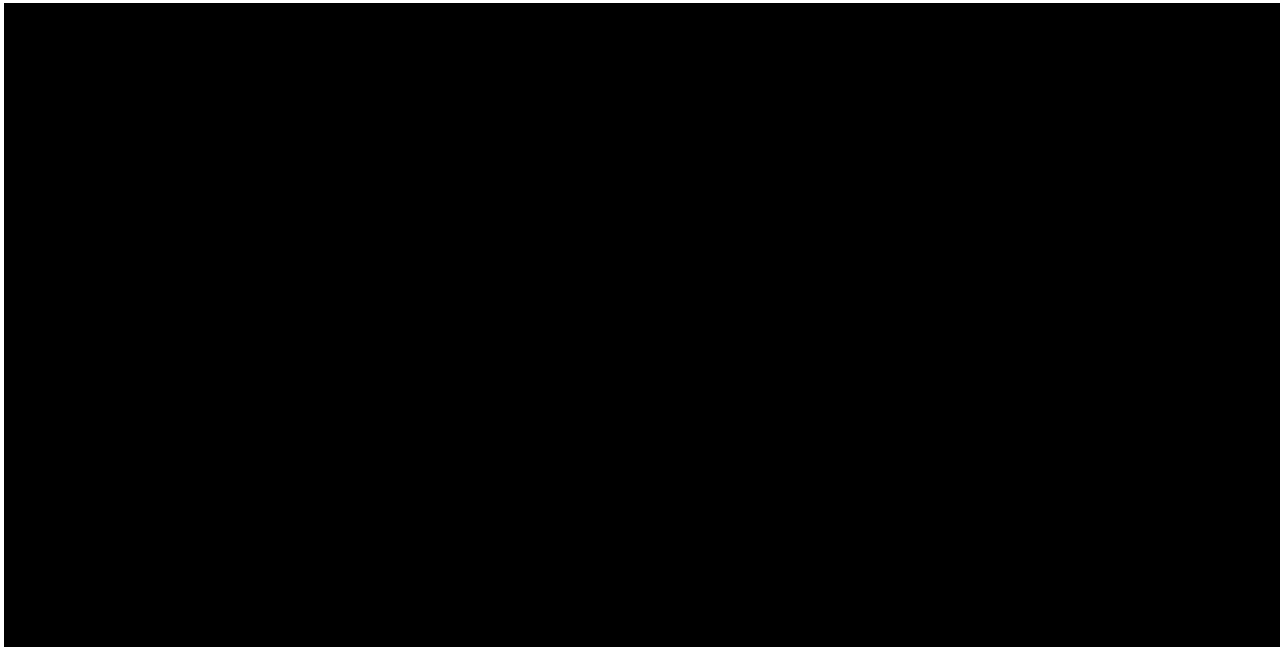
On May 28, 2026, 17 days after the University issued its response, Grayson replied to the University within the NextRequest FOIA portal for FOIA request 26-968, providing additional search parameters in the form of questions, including requests for searches by the Captain of Administrative Services, Chief of Police, and Vice Chancellor for Administration and Operations.

The University informed Grayson on the same day that FOIA requires public bodies to produce existing records and does not require them to answer questions. The request had been processed and completed using the information provided in the original request.

Grayson's April 20 request did not identify any specific employee or custodian to search outside of the selection for "University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Police Department" in the FOIA Office's NextRequest FOIA portal. Accordingly, the University exercised its reasonable judgment in identifying the department's personnel most likely to maintain responsive records.

Nevertheless, the University confirmed, after consultation with DPS, that no responsive records could be located, even when considering Grayson's additional post-response information and modified scope.

This information below is confidential and is not to be shared with the Requester:



End of confidential section

Accordingly, even when considering the additional individuals identified by Grayson after the University's response, the University could not locate any responsive records to items 1-4 of his request.

Adequacy of Search: Item 5

As above, the FOIA request was forwarded to DPS personnel for review and to search for responsive records.

This information below is confidential and is not to be shared with the Requester:



End of confidential section

Accordingly, the University could not locate any responsive records to Grayson's request.

CONCLUSION

For the reasons above, the University maintains that it has properly responded to the FOIA request, searched all likely locations where records would reasonably be found, and informed the requester when no records could be located. Therefore, the University respectfully requests that the PAC deny any relief requested by the Requester in this Request for Review.

If I can help further, please call me at 217-333-6400.

Sincerely,

Adrienne Nazon
Vice President, External Relations and
Communications
and Chief Records Officer

cc: Andrew Marlan, Associate Director of FOIA Administration